Ryanair backs ETS extension to all flights to and from the EU

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【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By TOMMASO LECCA with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Ryanair has renewed its suppor

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SNEAK PEEK

— Ryanair has renewed its support for extending the ETS to all flights departing from and arriving in the EU, breaking ranks with airline lobby A4E.

— European Parliament negotiators say they remain on track to close the EU's military mobility regulation at a final negotiation on Dec. 9.

— The European People's Party, the Socialists and Democrats, and Renew groups agreed to lower the EU's 2035 emissions reduction target for automakers to 87.5% of 2021 levels.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

DRIVING THE DAY

RYANAIR RENEWS CALL FOR ETS ON ALL EU FLIGHTS: While other major European airlines are pushing to maintain the current geographical scope of the Emissions Trading System when it comes to aviation, Ryanair wants carbon pricing extended to all flights departing from and arriving in the EU, CEO Michael O'Leary told Tommaso on Tuesday.

Why it matters: Ryanair had long advocated for the ETS to include long-haul flights. It changed tack in 2024, aligning itself with lobby group Airlines4Europe's common position , calling for EU carbon prices to be brought into line with those under the cheaper U.N. CORSIA scheme. But with Ryanair now threatening to quit A4E by the end of the year over a legal dispute involving fellow members Lufthansa and Air France-KLM, O'Leary says the airline will be "free to campaign" for an extended ETS scope.

Tax the poor: Responding to the European Commission's proposal to expand the ETS to EU departures to the Middle East and North Africa, O'Leary said: "If they're really serious about emissions, start taxing the Americans, the Chinese and the Asians when they land and take off in Europe." Referring to the current carbon pricing scope, he added, "It is utterly indefensible" to exempt long-haul flights. "They account for 53% of European aviation CO2 emissions, and the only people we tax are the poor, dumb Europeans and their families going on holidays to Spain." A4E did not respond to a request for

comment.

Make no mistake: Although Ryanair's position on the ETS scope now aligns with that of some environmental NGOs, O'Leary remains critical of other EU climate measures. He called the Commission's proposal to reserve up to 3 million ETS allowances for airlines incorporating contrail forecasting into flight paths — a measure aimed at encouraging airlines to tackle their non-CO2 climate warming emissions — "a complete scam." "They won't create an incentive, all they'll create is another round of costs," he added.

Speaking of costs: With jet fuel prices remaining elevated, the Ryanair boss expects European airfares to rise by up to 20% next year, but said his airline would limit its own fare increases to between 10% and 15%, absorbing part of the additional fuel costs.

Brussels expats, read this: Ryanair is also pushing back against higher national aviation taxes. In response to Belgium's increase in its aviation tax from €2 in 2025 to €7 next year, the Irish carrier plans to cut 20 routes from its Belgian airports starting this winter. Passengers flying from Zaventem's Brussels Airport will lose Ryanair services to Rome Fiumicino, Madrid, Porto, Marrakech, Valencia, Málaga and Barcelona. From Charleroi, Ryanair will discontinue routes to Warsaw Modlin, Sarajevo, Genoa and several other cities.

AVIATION

PARLIAMENT GREEN-LIGHTS NEW RULES ON PASSENGER RIGHTS ENFORCEMENT: MEPs on Tuesday backed new rules — which passed with 652 votes in favor, two against and eight abstentions — aimed at strengthening the enforcement of passenger rights.

The text will give air passengers who book tickets through an intermediary, such as an online travel agency, the right to receive a refund covering both the ticket price and the intermediary's fee within 14 days in the event of a travel disruption. Passengers would also be able to submit claims using standardized forms, which would be made available on the Commission's website.

Air pax nostalgia: Rapporteur Matteo Ricci of the Socialists & Democrats faced questions about the cumulative impact on airlines of the new enforcement rules and the broader air passenger rights reform , which completed negotiations earlier this year.

No worries: "I don't think Ryanair or any other company is going to be less competitive if it enables that people with disabilities can have a companion traveling with them free of charge," Ricci told reporters referring to the broader reform. "We think that this is actually enhancing the competitiveness of airlines with regard to one of the major issues that we have, which is accessibility," he added.

MILITARY MOBILITY

MILITARY MOBILITY HEADS FOR DECEMBER SHOWDOWN: Parliament and Council negotiators say they remain on track to close the EU's military mobility regulation at a final trilogue on Dec. 9, after a second round of political talks in Strasbourg on Tuesday.

Where things stand: Parliament co-rapporteurs Michał Szczerba and Roberts Zīle described the talks as productive but gave little away on compromises, saying negotiations covered close partners including Ukraine and Moldova, uninterrupted military transport and how the future system should work. Technical negotiations will continue ahead of December.

Still to crack: The emergency provisions are being left for the final trilogue. Parliament is also pushing for simpler and faster procedures, NATO interoperability, secure digitalization and resilient roads, railways, bridges, ports and airports. The MEPs also warned that the rules will need investment behind them, pushing back against proposed cuts to military mobility funding in the next EU budget.

MARITIME

ARCTIC ROUTE REALITY CHECK: Brussels' new Arctic strategy, published on Tuesday, puts emerging shipping routes firmly on Europe's economic security map, but experts caution that the Northern Sea Route is still a long way from becoming a serious alternative to the Suez Canal.

Traffic is rising: Michael Kingston, a special adviser to the Arctic Council, a high-level intergovernmental forum bringing together eight Arctic countries, told Martina that the number of ships operating in the Polar Code area — international regulations covering shipping in the Arctic and Antarctic — rose 40% between 2013 and 2025.

But don't reroute your boxes yet: Kingston said unpredictable ice and harsh conditions make the route unrealistic for major shipping lines that depend on reliable schedules, with icebreaker assistance, strengthened vessels and higher insurance costs all adding to the bill. Ksenia Vakhrusheva, who monitors shadow-fleet traffic in the region, made a similar point: the NSR remains a seasonal route used mainly to export Russian oil and LNG, and she does not expect it to become commercially viable for large-scale transit in the near future because of weather, ice, vessel requirements and insurance costs.

Brussels is preparing anyway: The strategy calls for a study of future Arctic shipping corridors, traffic and ice conditions, while linking European ports and rail networks more closely to emerging maritime flows. It also promises tougher maritime surveillance, more European icebreaker capacity and stronger enforcement of international shipping rules.

Martina has more here .

EU CRITICIZES TURKISH-LIBYAN ACCORD: The European Union strongly criticized the ratification of a maritime memorandum with Turkey by the eastern Libyan parliament in Benghazi. "This agreement infringes upon the sovereign rights of third states, it does not comply with the Law of the Sea, and is null and void," European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and the President of the European Council Antonio Costa said in a joint statement , adding that they reaffirm their solidarity with Greece and Cyprus.

Rift revival: Back in 2019 by Turkey and Libya's Tripoli-based government signed an agreement that they said established a maritime boundary across the eastern Mediterranean. Greece and Cyprus criticized it as an attempt to fence off parts of the sea that they regard as theirs, and the EU also condemned the ratification.

Athens, Nicosia react: Greece will take "every appropriate action to safeguard its sovereign rights," the foreign ministry said in a statement, while minister Giorgos Gerapetritis spoke with his counterparts from Cyprus and Egypt to organize their next steps.

CARS

EPP, S&D, RENEW STRIKE DEAL ON CAR EMISSIONS: The center-right European People's Party, centrist Renew, and center-left Socialists & Democrats have struck a deal on EU's 2035 emissions

reduction target for automakers that would require carmakers to slash the emissions of their vehicles by 87.5% by 2035. Jordyn has more here .

At first sight, this looks like a less climate-friendly position than either the Commission or member countries are pushing for (they both want a 90% emissions reduction target). But it's not so simple, James Fernyhough reports.

Back in December, the Commission proposed walking back the EU target to reduce vehicle emissions by 100% by 2035 — effectively a ban on the sale of combustion engine cars. The new emissions target for 2035 would be 90%. That last 10%, however, would need to be offset with investment in EU-made green steel or green fuels.

France and Germany last week struck a deal that would keep the 90% emissions cut, but scrap entirely the conditional investment in green steel or biofuels.

Parliament: The EPP-S&D-Renew deal sets the emissions reduction at 87.5%, but requires 7.5 percentage points to be offset with green steel. So it's both more and less ambitious than France and Germany's proposal, depending on how you look at it.

PIT STOPS

According to the latest Eurocontrol seven-year forecast , European flight growth is expected to average 2.1% annually from 2026 to 2032.

A new Transport & Environment report estimates that a moderate implementation of the EU's Clean Corporate Vehicles Regulation could generate €11 billion in additional value, nearly 196,000 jobs and €11 billion in extra investment by 2030.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Europe's conservatives have 2 new targets in their campaign to weaken EU climate laws
The EPP is taking aim at a new carbon price on driving and heating, and rules on methane emissions.
By Ben Munster, Ben Makuch · Oct 20, 2026, 09:15 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

5 things the EU wants to change about its Arctic policy
As melting ice opens new routes and access to resources in the North, the EU wants piece of the cake.
By Martina Sapio, Marianne Gros · Oct 20, 2026, 06:47 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Ryanair's O'Leary warns of 'biggest increase' in EU airfares next year
High fuel prices could push up ticket prices and force airlines to cut capacity as their hedging contracts expire.
By Tommaso Lecca · Oct 20, 2026, 01:59 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: Conservative lawmakers move to kill ETS2
Close to half of EPP delegations want to abolish or delay the new carbon price on transport and heating.
By Ben Makuch · Oct 20, 2026, 12:21 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Parliament groups reach agreement on CO2 standards for cars
EU institutions are reworking the bloc's policy on cutting emissions from cars.
By Jordyn Dahl · Oct 20, 2026, 11:56 am Europe/Brussels CEST

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